

Baby Bottle Refusal Return To Work — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

DIAGNOSE THE ROOT CAUSE

- ☐ **Diagnose the Root Cause:** Identify whether your baby gags when milk flows, accepts bottles from others but not you, or screams and tenses up entirely, because each symptom requires a different solution approach.
- ☐ **Diagnose the Root Cause:** Watch for flow mismatch by noting if your baby sputters or chokes on the bottle nipple, since this indicates the milk is coming too fast for their learned breastfeeding pace.
- ☐ **Diagnose the Root Cause:** Determine if your baby has an association problem by testing whether they take the bottle from your partner but refuse it from you, which signals they know you're the preferred food source.
- ☐ **Diagnose the Root Cause:** Notice if your own stress is transferring to your baby during feeding attempts, because anxious parents create anxious babies who won't eat regardless of technique.

USE TARGETED TECHNIQUES

- ☐ **Use Targeted Techniques:** Start with the slowest-flow nipple available and dip it in expressed breast milk before offering, letting your baby lick and explore it without forcing the bottle into their mouth.
- ☐ **Use Targeted Techniques:** Have your partner or another caregiver feed your baby while you leave the house entirely for association-based refusals, because your baby can hold out for the real thing when they see you holding them.
- ☐ **Use Targeted Techniques:** Offer the bottle as play rather than a meal when your baby is slightly drowsy or just waking, reducing pressure and tapping into the more relaxed state between sleep cycles.
- ☐ **Use Targeted Techniques:** Practice paced bottle feeding by holding your baby upright, keeping the bottle horizontal, and pausing every few sucks to mimic breastfeeding rhythms and prevent flow preference.

SELECT THE RIGHT EQUIPMENT

- ☐ **Select the Right Equipment:** Choose bottles specifically designed for breastfed babies with slow-flow nipples, wider bases that mimic the breast, and nipples that collapse slightly during feeding.
 - ☐ **Select the Right Equipment:** Test bottles from brands like Lansinoh, Medela, or Tommee Tippee that are explicitly marketed for breastfed babies, because standard bottles flow too quickly for your baby's learned pace.
 - ☐ **Select the Right Equipment:** Try multiple bottle styles if the first option fails, since every baby has individual preferences and what works for one baby may not work for yours.
 - ☐ **Select the Right Equipment:** Give yourself the full two-week sprint window with consistent daily practice rather than giving up after one or two unsuccessful attempts, because most babies need repeated exposure before accepting a new feeding method.
-

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.